

COUPLES THERAPY AGREEMENT

Statements of understanding	Please tick
I have read and understood the couples therapy agreement outlined below and am willing to participate in couples therapy under these terms.	
I understand that all clinical information shared with my therapist will remain confidential within their service except where they believe there may be a risk of harm to myself or others, or where there's a legal or ethical duty of disclosure.	
ONLY IF YOU ATTEND SESSION AT THE REGENCY PRACTICE: I understand that a security camera is installed in the entrance hall of The Regency Practice, 22A Rodney Road, GL50 1JJ to monitor the front door for security purposes. Footage is automatically deleted after 7 days and is accessible only to Bobby Hook and Katrina Woodward (the providers of therapy rooms at the Regency Practice).	
I understand that my therapist has case supervision with their supervisor where a broad outline of my case may be discussed as a part of the supervisory process and that no identifying details will be revealed.	
I understand that if my therapy is being delivered via the telephone or a teleconferencing platform that no platform is 100% secure although every effort is made to use only those platforms that have been deemed to offer good quality security. Recording of sessions will be undertaken by either party only with informed, explicit consent.	
I have read and understood the Fees and Terms of Business document.	
I have read the Privacy Notice and understand that any data held or processed by my therapist will be done so in accordance with the Data Protection Act (2018) and General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). In relation to this personal data, which will include case record notes, contact information and written correspondence (whether by email, letter or online messaging service) I understand that there is lawful basis for processing this personal information: legitimate business interests relating to the service being provided, legal duty and entering into or performing the contract between us. I further understand that my therapist will ● use my contact details only to get in touch with me about matters relating to my treatment, such as appointments and to provide helpful information, where appropriate. ● not share my personal information with other individuals or organisations, except where they have reason to believe that I or others to be at risk of harm, or where there is a legal duty to disclose it. ● retain a record of my treatment for a period of 7 years, in accordance with professional and insurance requirements and will take steps to ensure the accuracy and security of the record. ● provide me with access to the information they hold about me, if I request it.	
I understand the arrangements regarding payment for sessions and cancellation fees as outlined in the Fees and Terms of Business document.	

Couples Therapy Agreement

Purpose of Couples Therapy

Couples therapy is a collaborative process designed to help partners better understand their relationship patterns, improve communication, address conflict, and work toward mutually agreed goals. In couples therapy, **the relationship itself is considered the client**, and the work focuses on the wellbeing of the relationship as well as each partner's experience within it. The primary goal is to **support both partners in creating a healthier, more functional relationship**, repair trust, and build skills for ongoing communication and problem-solving.

Individual Sessions

Individual sessions may be scheduled for one partner when necessary to support the **overall goals of couples therapy**. These sessions provide a private space to:

- Reflect on personal emotions, thoughts, or behaviours affecting the relationship.
- Process difficult feelings, such as anger, hurt, or betrayal.
- Explore personal triggers or patterns impacting communication or conflict resolution.
- Develop strategies and coping skills to contribute more constructively to the relationship.

Individual sessions are **part of the couples therapy process** and are subject to the **No Secrets Policy**. If a partner requires personal therapy **unrelated to couples work** or wishes to continue individual therapy after couples therapy ends, I will **signpost or refer them to another qualified therapist** to ensure appropriate support and maintain professional boundaries.

Confidentiality of individual sessions

All therapy sessions are confidential within legal and ethical limits. Exceptions include situations where there is a risk of harm to yourself or others, or where disclosure is required by law or professional ethics.

Honesty and transparency are foundational to effective couples therapy. If one partner shares information in an individual session that significantly impacts the relationship—such as an ongoing affair, undisclosed contact with a third party, hidden financial activity, major deception, secret plans to end the relationship, or other serious breaches of trust—I will encourage and support that partner in bringing this issue into joint sessions. However, if they wish the information to remain confidential, therapy may be paused until the matter can be addressed openly, or it may not be possible to continue with the therapy.

Respectful Communication and Safety

Couples therapy requires a respectful and emotionally safe environment. If conversations become **aggressive, hostile, intimidating, or disrespectful**, I may pause or redirect the discussion to help regulate the interaction and maintain a constructive space. Breaks or topic shifts may occur as needed. Ongoing patterns of intimidation, threats, or abuse may require reassessment of whether couples therapy is appropriate.

Therapist Neutrality

I aim to remain **neutral and balanced**, supporting the wellbeing of the relationship rather than taking sides. Challenges or interventions are designed to facilitate constructive dialogue and personal reflection, not to assign blame or determine who is “right” or “wrong.”

Communication Between Sessions

Email, text, or phone contact between sessions is intended for **practical matters only**, such as scheduling or cancellations. Therapeutic discussions, relationship conflicts, or detailed concerns are best addressed during sessions where both partners are present. Individual messages about relationship matters may be brought into therapy and are subject to the **No Secrets Policy**.

Responsibility for Change

Couples therapy is most effective when both partners actively participate and take responsibility for their own behaviours, communication patterns, and contributions to relationship dynamics. Therapy provides guidance, tools, and a structured space for discussion, but meaningful change depends on the **efforts and willingness of both partners** to engage both inside and outside of sessions.

Limits on Use of Therapy in Legal Proceedings

Couples therapy is intended as a therapeutic service, not a forensic or legal service. I do not provide evaluations, reports, or testimony for court proceedings (including divorce or custody disputes) based on couples therapy work. Therapy notes and communications are kept confidential within the limits of the law, but I cannot guarantee protection from legal subpoena if records are requested by a court.

If the Couple Separates

If the relationship ends during or after therapy, I may not be able to continue seeing **one partner individually** due to potential conflicts of interest. In such situations, I may recommend referral to another therapist to ensure professional boundaries and fairness to both parties. If a partner wishes to continue **individual therapy after couples therapy ends**, I will provide referrals to qualified therapists for ongoing personal support.

Signed _____ Date _____

PRINT NAME _____